

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA
COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in regular session on Monday, February 16, 2026, at 5:00 p.m. in the commissioners’ conference room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Charisse Fain; Commissioners: R. Dan Brummitt, Thomas S. Hester, Jr., Leo Kelly, Jr., Valencia L. Perry, and Yolanda Feimster

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Dywanda Pettaway.

Reverend Joseph Ratliff, Shiloh Baptist Church, gave the invocation.

Mr. Frankie Nobles, Vance County Employee Engagement Team member, was first on the agenda to recognize the new employee of the month. Employees are nominated by their peers, and this month’s recognition goes to Ms. Danita Thomas with the Vance County Department of Social Services. Her peers noted that she is always willing to help others, takes initiative on issues, is a team player, and is extremely dependable. Ms. Thomas will receive a monetary gift and a designated parking space for the month. She was presented with a plaque of appreciation, and the board congratulated her on receiving this recognition.

Public comments were heard next. Angie Ryan spoke to the board on the topic of broadband and public safety. Andrew Coleman addressed the board on the water service \$30 a month payment fee. He was asked by the board to leave his contact information with Mr. Nobles so more information could be provided about the fee.

Tax Administrator Jennifer Williams was next on the agenda and presented the following untimely exemption applications for approval. She stated that if the applications had been submitted by the deadline, she would have approved them at the staff level.

Untimely Exemptions

Name	Exemption Requested	Tax Administrator’s Recommendation
Barbara Thomas 1430 N Chavis Rd PIN 0479 03004	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Barbara Harper 535 Sagefield Dr. PIN 0108 03018	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Brian A. and April Ellington		

PIN 0529 02002, 0212 02030, 0212 02004, 0212 02001, 0528 02018, 0534 02004, & 0212 02031	Present Use of Agriculture and Forestry	Approve Application
Carol Franklin 1643 S. Garnett Street Ext. PIN 0017 03007	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Donald Hicks 411 Pearl St. PIN 0101 04012	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Helen Greer 702 S Carolina Ave. PIN 0088 06012	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Herbert Newcomb 505 Parham Rd. PIN 0037A04001	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Joel Sr. & Linda H. Harris PIN 0431 05007	Present Use of Agriculture and Forestry	Approve Application
Rhonda Lewis-Brown 1102 S Garrett St. PIN 0005 06002	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Scarlet Davis 221 Sam Brummitt Rd. PIN 0600B03001	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Shelia Barnes 151 Stewart Farm Rd. PIN 0528 01066	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application
Steven C. Rogers PIN 0350 02008, 0350 02040, & 0350 02043	Present Use of Agriculture and Forestry	Approve Application
Venise Kersey 1025 Foster Rd. PIN 0550 01043	Elderly/Disabled Exemption	Approve Application

Motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote unanimous, to approve the elderly/disabled exemptions and the present use forestry exemption as requested.

Chief Marvin Harrison was next on the agenda and provided an update to the board on the Vance County Fire Department. The board was informed that the Fire Department had just received their median rescue and emergency medical responder certificates from the North Carolina Rescue and EMS Commission. These certifications represent far more than coursework completed. They reflect preparation, commitment, and a higher level of service to citizens of Vance County. Mr. Harrison also thanked the board of commissioners for their continued support and confidence in our department. We are continuing to pursue additional training and certifications, raising the professional standard across, not just the Fire Department, but also the Volunteer Departments with the same commitment and dedication.

Finance Director's Report

Explanation for expenditures over 50% are as follows: 519 - payment of principal and lease payment, 520- payment of emergency pay and inmate housing to surrounding counties during the jail renovation, 531- payment of equipment needed- UTV, Drones, Boat, Airpack and Trailer, 555- payment in full of WComp & Liability insurance; payment of utilities and fuel for all department except DSS, 580- slightly over the 50% threshold, a budget amendment was done in January to budget for additional revenue to be received from ABC Revenue and Expenditures to remit payments to Vaya Health, 622- bank charges fees; all of the TNH Bucks which is 20% of the dept budget has been spent, 630- increase in insurance and salary, 683- payment of principal and lease payment resulted in the percent overage 50% and 999 – amount for clean-up of rental property after tenant vacancy, HVIP, card access to FD. As of the day of this report, revenue exceeds expenditure by \$6,590,998.51.

Resolution of Bank Depository. Finance Director Stephanie Williams presented to the board for consideration of approval a resolution of bank depository. After further discussion, a motion made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, vote was unanimous, to approve the resolution of bank depository.

Location: Henderson, North Carolina

WHEREAS, pursuant to North Carolina General Statutes § 159-31, the governing board of each local government shall designate official depositories for public funds and report the names and

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED, by the Board of Commissioners of County of Vance, North Carolina, that the following financial institutions are hereby designated as official depositories of the County funds:

- and that accounts may be opened and maintained by the County in such depositories as necessary and appropriate for the receipt, deposit, and disbursement of County funds in accordance with applicable North Carolina law and LGC regulations.

Name	Title
C. Renee Perry	County Manager
Stephanie Williams	Finance Director

FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Finance Director shall ensure that all deposits of County funds are properly secured in accordance with applicable North Carolina law, under the supervision of the Local Government Commission of the North Carolina State Treasurer, and that all required reports regarding accounts and deposits are submitted to the LGC as required by statute.

I, the undersigned Clerk to the Board of Commissioners of County of Vance, North Carolina, hereby certify that the foregoing resolution was duly adopted by the Board at a regular meeting held on February 16, 2026, at which a quorum was present and voting throughout, and that the same is a true and correct copy of the resolution adopted by the Board.

Dywanda Pettaway, Clerk to the Board

(County Seal)

Fee Schedule Amendment. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones reported that Vance

These events require dedicated EMS staffing and equipment and are currently provided without a

standardized fee. Under the proposal, employees will be compensated through the normal payroll process rather than off duty pay. The new fee will help recover operational costs, promote transparency, and support the sustainability of EMS services while maintaining high-quality care at special events. Recommendation is to approve the new fee for special events.

Motion made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the new fee for special events.

Medical Director Contract Renewal. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones reported that Vance County EMS is proposing to update the Medical Director contract for Dr. Richard Benson, whose current contract expired on June 30, 2024. The amount will be \$32,000 with a 2-year automatic renewal. Dr. Benson will continue to provide medical oversight and guidance to EMS operations, ensuring compliance with clinical standards and supporting high-quality patient care. Updating this contract supports operational continuity and maintains established medical leadership for the department. Recommendation is to approve the Medical Director's \$32,000 contract with a 2-year automatic renewal.

Motion made by Commissioner Charisse Fain, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the Medical Director's \$32,000 contract with a 2-year automatic renewal.

Vance County Dress and Appearance Policy. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones presented to the board for consideration of approval a new dress and appearance policy. This policy establishes clear dress, appearance, and hygiene standards for all Vance County employees to ensure professionalism, safety, and appropriate representation of the County to the public. It defines business casual attire as the standard Monday through Thursday, outlines acceptable and prohibited clothing, and allows for casual dress on designated days while maintaining reasonable limits.

The policy acknowledges that certain positions require uniforms or alternative attire due to the nature of their duties, with department-specific standards approved by the County Manager. As part of this administration's ongoing efforts, the policy reflects the implementation of much-needed, clearly defined workplace standards that promote consistency, fairness, and accountability across all departments. The need for this policy is to reduce ambiguity, support supervisors in enforcement, enhance employee professionalism, and strengthen public trust in County

government through clear and modern administrative practices. Recommendation is to approve the Vance County Dress and Appearance Policy.

Motion made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the Vance County Dress and Appearance Policy as presented.

Winter Storm Fern 2026. Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones presented to the board a resolution. This resolution is presented to formally thank and recognize all individuals and agencies who responded during Vance County's recent State of Emergency and the operation of the warming center. It acknowledges the exceptional efforts of Vance County staff, the City of Henderson and its staff, the Vance County Sheriff's Office, Volunteer Fire Departments, NCDOT, volunteers, elected officials, and our many local, regional, and state partnering agencies. Despite challenging conditions, these teams demonstrated professionalism, coordination, and compassion, often working extended hours to ensure essential services continued without interruption. This resolution reflects the Board's appreciation for that collective response and recognizes the resilience, service, and community partnership that made the emergency operations successful. Recommendation is to approve adoption of the resolution to formally express the Board's gratitude on behalf of the citizens of Vance County and ensure this recognition is entered into the official record.

Motion made by Commissioner Yolanda Feimster, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, to approve the adoption of the resolution to formally express the Board's gratitude on behalf of the citizens of Vance County and ensure this recognition is entered into the official record.



VANCE COUNTY

RESOLUTION OF APPRECIATION AND GRATITUDE

In Recognition of Collective Efforts During the Recent State of Emergency

WHEREAS, severe winter weather conditions necessitated the declaration of a State of Emergency in Vance County to protect the health, safety, and welfare of residents; and

WHEREAS, the activation and operation of a warming center required coordinated planning, staffing, and emergency response efforts across multiple agencies and jurisdictions; and

WHEREAS, Vance County employees from multiple departments responded with professionalism, dedication, and flexibility—many working extended hours under challenging conditions to ensure continuity of essential services; and

WHEREAS, the City of Henderson and its staff worked in close partnership with Vance County to support emergency operations, transportation, and warming center logistics; and

WHEREAS, the North Carolina Department of Transportation (NCDOT) provided vital assistance in maintaining roadway safety and accessibility during hazardous weather conditions; and

WHEREAS, elected officials and additional local, regional, and state partnering agencies provided leadership, coordination, and support to ensure an effective and unified emergency response;

- Vance County staff
- City of Henderson staff
- Vance County Sheriff's Office
- Volunteer Fire Departments
- North Carolina Department of Transportation
- Volunteers and community partners
- Elected officials
- All local, regional, and state partnering agencies

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Board recognizes these collective efforts as a demonstration of the strength, resilience, and compassion of the Vance County community and of public service at its highest standard; and

ADOPTED this 16th day of February, 2026.

Chair

County Manager's Report

Motion made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the adoption of the resolution in support of the designation of February as Black History Month in Vance County.

WHEREAS, for 99 years in the United States, at least some part of the month of February has been observed in recognition of black history and the many accomplishments and contributions made to society by African Americans; and

WHEREAS, the second week of February was selected by Carter Woodson, a noted Washington, D.C. author, editor, historian, and publisher, to defend black humanity and highlight the accomplishments of his ancestors; and

WHEREAS, in 1976 the entire month of February was included in the bicentennial celebration of the United States, and every single American President has since designated February as National Black History Month; and

WHEREAS, since 2006, the Vance County Board of Commissioners has annually established February as a special month to recognize and celebrate the essential roles of African Americans throughout Vance County; and

WHEREAS, the Board of County Commissioners sincerely desires for all citizens to thoroughly understand and appreciate value added to the local economy and overall community by African Americans of all socio-economic levels.

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does officially designate February 2026 as Black History Month in Vance County, and in doing so, does recognize the accomplishments and countless significant contributions made to society by individuals of African heritage.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Vance County Board of Commissioners does encourage businesses, churches, civic organizations, schools, and citizens of all races and color to actively participate in the observance and celebration of Black History Month in Vance County during the month of February 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair

[illegible]

Jail Health Contract. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that over the past several weeks, the current jail medical provider (ACH) submitted a Best and Final Offer (BAFO) outlining two staffing options intended to provide 24/7 medical coverage at the Detention Center. The provider cited ongoing staffing instability, including nurse resignations and reassignment requests, as the basis for the proposed changes. Along with the BAFO, the provider formally issued a 120-day Notice of Termination, with services ending April 16, 2026, unless the County elects to transition sooner. The BAFO options include increased nursing coverage, behavioral health services, implementation of an electronic medical records system with a one-time start-up fee, and additional staffing contingencies to address continued turnover. Staff has evaluated these options in the context of service reliability, cost, and long-term operational risk. In parallel, County staff has met with three additional correctional healthcare providers to assess alternatives.

Based on those discussions, staff is recommending Southern Health Partners as the preferred provider. Southern Health Partners offers the most cost-effective proposal for the County while still meeting required standards of care. Their pricing structure provides predictable costs, reduces exposure to unplanned staffing premiums, and minimizes financial risk associated with turnover and emergency coverage. Southern Health Partners previously held the medical services contract with Vance County and departed due to documented safety concerns at that time. Recommendation is to approve Southern Health Partners as the new jail health provider and authorize the County Manager, County Attorney, and the Vance County Sheriff (or designee) to negotiate contract terms with Southern Health Partners.

Motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve Southern Health Partners as the new jail health provider and authorize the County Manager, County Attorney, and the Vance County Sheriff (or designee) to negotiate contract terms with Southern Health Partners.

Board Goals for FY 2026-27. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that the following goals were prioritized during the retreat for FY 2026-2027., Tax Assessing Technician, as review officers as required by NC General Statute 47-30. Recommendation is to approve the goals as presented.

Motion was made by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve goals as presented for FY 2026-27.



Board Goals for FY 2026-27

- ✓ **Goal 1** – Host countywide town hall/community engagement sessions with Commissioners and staff and expand public education and outreach.
- ✓ **Goal 2** – Retain or assist in the creation of 150 new jobs and \$10 million in new investment.
- ✓ **Goal 3** – Improve relationship with city elected leaders - partner together on large projects that will bring economic development and increased quality of life to citizens of the entire county.
- ✓ **Goal 4** - Schedule and participate in a joint meeting with the Vance County Board of Education to review student performance, workforce readiness, facility needs, and partnership opportunities that support improved outcomes for students and families. This effort should promote shared planning, aligned priorities, and accountability between County leadership and School District leadership to ensure that Vance County students have the education, support, and resources necessary to thrive.
- ✓ **Goal 5** – Develop and implement a comprehensive strategy for opioid settlement funds that focuses on prevention, early intervention, treatment, and recovery programs for individuals and families affected by substance abuse disorder. This goal includes working with the Opioid Advisory Committee, community partners, and service providers to ensure funds are allocated effectively, equitably, and in alignment with state-approved uses to support long-term healing and community resilience.
- ✓ **Goal 6** - Actively pursue and support public-private partnerships that prepare, develop, and market sites for business expansion, industrial recruitment, and job creation. This includes collaborating with developers, landowners, utility providers, and state/local economic development partners to increase the number of shovel-ready sites, enhance infrastructure, and position Vance County as a competitive location for new investment and long-term economic growth.
- ✓ **Goal 7** - Maintain momentum on all Board-approved capital projects, ensuring they move forward on schedule, within budget, and in alignment with Board priorities. This includes key projects such as the new detention center, EMS substation, EMS/Fire station, facility renovations, and other funded long-term infrastructure initiatives, with regular progress updates provided to the Board and the public.



Revaluation Cycle Change. County Manager C. Renee Perry reported that at the Board’s annual retreat on January 9, 2026, there was consensus to shorten the County’s property revaluation cycle from the current eight years. Included in your agenda packet is a resolution for the Board’s consideration to formally adopt a six-year revaluation cycle. Recommendation is to approve the resolution to formally adopt a six-year revaluation cycle.

After further discussion, a motion was made by Commissioner Tommy Hester, Jr., seconded by Commissioner Valencia Perry, motion passed with a 6-1 vote, with Commissioner Dan Brummitt voting no, to approve the resolution to formally adopt a six-year revaluation cycle.

Fiscal Year 2026-2027 Budget. County Manager C. Renee Perry stated that as we move into FY 26/27 budget development, I respectfully ask that any questions or requests for clarification be directed to me and my staff in advance of the May budget presentation. Early engagement will allow us to provide complete and accurate information and make any necessary adjustments before the proposed budget is formally presented. Following the May presentation, meeting directly with staff to discuss specific concerns will be far more beneficial than attempting

March 16, 2026, Work Session. County Manager C. Renee Perry requested the board to change the March work session from March 16, 2026 @ 4PM to March 17, 2026 @ 4 PM. Chair Faines has a scheduling conflict due to her position on the VGCC Trustee Board. Recommendation is to approve moving the March work session from March 16, 2026 @ 4PM to March 17, 2026 @ 4 PM.

Consent Agenda

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Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
4H Farm Bureau Revenue	10-334-433405	2,500
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$2,500
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
4H Farm Bureau Expenditure	10-604-500405	2,500
Total		\$2,500

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Budget Amendment #29
FY 2025-2026
Capital Projects

Revenue Amendment Request	Account Number	Revenue Increase (Decrease)
Fund Balance	10-399-439900	90,689.62
Total Revenue Increase (Decrease)		\$90,689.62
Expenditure Amendment Request	Account Number	Expense Increase (Decrease)
Capital Projects	10-696-500075	90,689.62
Total		\$90,689.62

Purpose: Request funding to cover Vance County’s match of our participation in the GREAT Grant. The agreement for the GREAT award is with the North Carolina Department of Information Technology. The funds are awarded based on the Grantee’s application and program requirements and must be used to deploy broadband infrastructure capable of providing at least 100/100 Mbps service to the identified locations by December 31, 2026 .

Authorization: Vance County Board of Commissioners
February 16, 2026

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TAX OFFICE REFUND AND RELEASE REPORT FOR DECEMBER 2025

TAXPAYER NAME	TAX YR	REAL	PERSONAL	SOLIDWASTE FEE	REASON
HARTLAND LAND COMPANY	2019	\$67.90	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP – BILL
HARTLAND LAND COMPANY	2020	\$67.90	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP – BILL
JOHNSON JAMES H III	2020	\$19.60	\$0.00	\$0.00	DUPLICATE PARCEL
HARTLAND LAND COMPANY	2021	\$67.90	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP - BILL
JOHNSON JAMES H III	2021	\$19.60	\$0.00	\$0.00	DUPLICATE PARCEL
HARTLAND LAND COMPANY	2022	\$67.90	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP - BILL
JOHNSON JAMES H III	2022	\$19.60	\$0.00	\$0.00	DUPLICATE PARCEL
JOHNSON JAMES H III	2023	\$20.07	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP - BILL
SMITH FAITH VAUGHAN	2023	\$1,003.79	\$0.00	\$0.00	CORRECT VALUE
SMITH FAITH VAUGHAN	2023	\$1,003.79	\$0.00	\$0.00	CORRECT VALUE
CAROLINA QUALITY RENTALS LLC	2024	\$282.33	\$0.00	\$0.00	MH BILLED AS PP
HARTLAND LAND COMPANY	2024	\$128.94	\$0.00	\$0.00	REAL PROP - BILL
HODGE DENNIS M	2024	\$199.64	\$0.00	\$0.00	NEW OWNER
HODGE DENNIS M	2024	\$210.80	\$0.00	\$0.00	NEW OWNER
JOHNSON JAMES H III	2024	\$299.84	\$0.00	\$0.00	DUPLICATE PARCEL
SMITH FAITH VAUGHAN	2024	\$1,695.35	\$0.00	\$0.00	CORRECT VALUE
BALBOA CAPITAL CORPORATION	2025	\$0.00	\$47.54	\$0.00	REMOVE LATE LIST
BALBOA CAPITAL CORPORATION	2025	\$0.00	\$47.54	\$0.00	REMOVE LATE LIST
BOWMAN LAND COMPANY	2025	\$225.75	\$0.00	\$0.00	CORRECT VALUE
BUILDER TONY HIRST LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$248.46	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BUILDER TONY HIRST LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$13.85	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BUILDER TONY HIRST LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$37.41	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BUILDER TONY HIRST LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$3.03	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED
BUILDER TONY HIRST LLC	2025	\$0.00	\$1.03	\$0.00	PERS PROP BILLED

Upon return to open session, motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to approve the adjourn the Water District Board. Chair Carolyn Faines adjourned the Water District Board.

At this time, motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr., vote was unanimous, to re-enter into closed session to discuss legal matters related to Gang Free.

Upon return to open session, and as there was no further business, at 6:34 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed March 2, 2026.

Carolyn Faines (signed)
Carolyn Faines, Chair